



- ↔ 10–20 ft (3–6 m)
- ⚖ 880–1,760 lb (400–800 kg)
- ⊗ Common
- 🐟 Fish, mammals, birds
- 🏠 



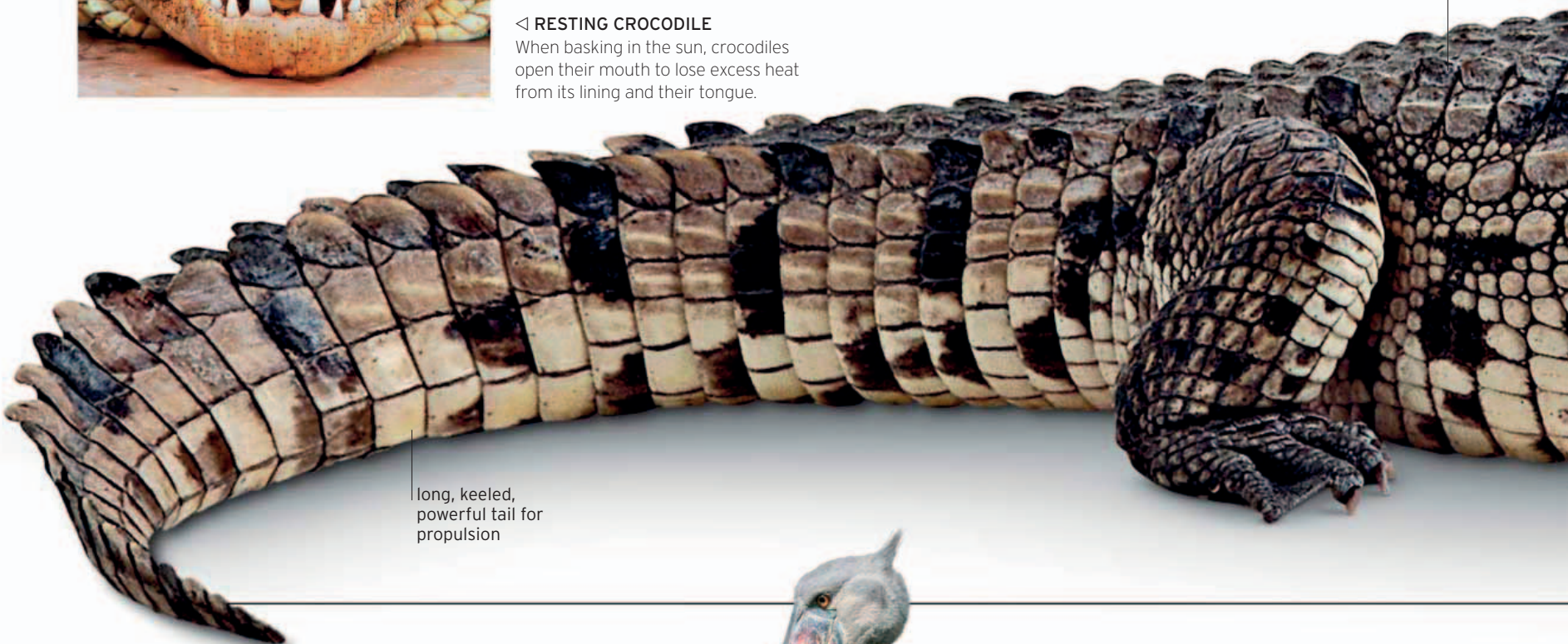
Africa, W.
Madagascar

◁ RESTING CROCODILE

When basking in the sun, crocodiles open their mouth to lose excess heat from its lining and their tongue.

Nile crocodiles often **roll their eggs gently in their mouths** to help **hatching babies** emerge

dorsal scales reinforced by underlying bony plates (scutes)



long, keeled, powerful tail for propulsion

Shoebill

Balaeniceps rex

clog-shaped bill gives rise to name

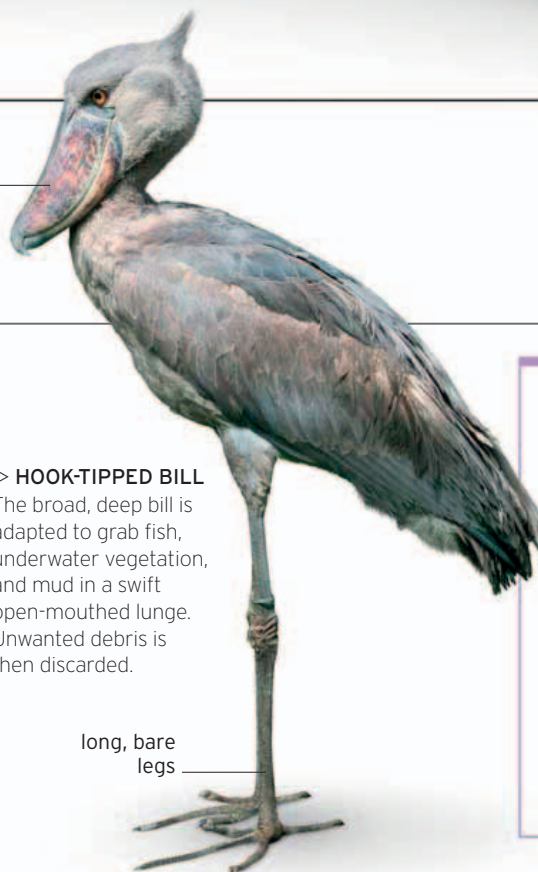
Pointed, hooked, saw-edged, and spoon-shaped beaks, even pelicans' flexible pouches, are all used to catch fish. However, only one other bird has such a broad, deep, hook-tipped bill as the shoebill. The boat-billed heron's smaller bill helps it to fish by touch at night, whereas the shoebill fishes by sight during the day.

The shoebill moves remarkably delicately for a bird of its size, walking through waterside vegetation, bill tilted down so it can look for fish. The bill is also used to cool overheating eggs and chicks in the nest by pouring water over them. The nest is a huge, flat mound of wet vegetation in shallow water, among reeds or papyrus. The female usually lays two eggs. The chicks have to feed themselves on regurgitated fish dropped into the nest because of the adults' unusual bill structure.

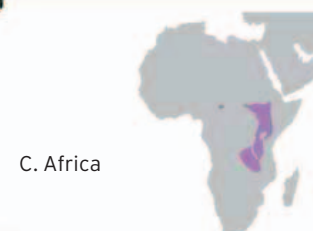
▷ HOOK-TIPPED BILL

The broad, deep bill is adapted to grab fish, underwater vegetation, and mud in a swift open-mouthed lunge. Unwanted debris is then discarded.

long, bare legs



- ↔ 4–5 ft (1–1.5 m)
- ⚖ 10–14 lb (4.5–6.5 kg)
- ⊗ Vulnerable
- 🐟 Lungfish, frogs
- 🏠 



C. Africa